

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

	COMM. 0.07	INDUS 0.41	MATER 0.47	UTILI 0.55	HEALT 0.64	REAL 0.91	CONS. 0.92	CONS. 1.09	ENERG 1.59	TECHN 2.61	FINAN 2.77
1	MU BUY \$910.43 -5.83% 8/10 HBM memory leader riding the AI capex supercycle with CHIPS Act subsid										
2	NVDA BUY \$208.48 -2.91% 8/10 The AI infrastructure buildout is a multi-year secular story and NVDA										
3	GOOGL BUY \$348.06 +0.94% 8/10 Alphabet is the cheapest of the Mag 7 with real AI product wins (Gemin										

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 38.4x normal volume, P/C 0.73, largest: PUT \$482 (3.8x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No major earnings this week

GDP (Quarterly)

Date: 2026-08-27

HIGH

VIX at 15.8 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

PCE Price Index [HIGH]

GDP (Quarterly) [HIGH]

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's interesting: the smart money is piling into the "old economy" trade — Communication Services, Industrials, Materials, and Utilities are seeing massive bullish call buying, which tells me institutions are positioning for an infrastructure and reshoring boom, likely tied to ongoing tariff policy, defense spending increases, and the AI power buildout that's forcing utilities into the spotlight (data centers need electricity, and lots of it).

Meanwhile, the same players are aggressively hedging or outright betting against Financials and Technology — the Financials put activity is especially loud at 15.8x normal volume, which usually signals worry about credit quality, net interest margin compression if the Fed cuts faster than expected, or fallout from regional bank stress that isn't in the headlines yet.

The credit market is confirming this darker view: both junk bonds (HYG) and investment-grade bonds (LQD) are seeing heavy put buying with spreads widening, meaning bond investors are demanding more compensation for risk — historically a warning shot that comes 4-8 weeks before equity volatility spikes.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.53/100
Leidos is the largest pure-play government IT/defense-tech contra			
2.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.53/100
SMCI is the leading AI server/rack integrator for NVIDIA Blackwel			
3.	MDB	MongoDB, Inc.	8.46/100
MongoDB's Atlas Vector Search is emerging as a preferred database			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 11–12	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$310.34** ▲ 0.32% 12M Price Target **\$355.00** 52-Week Range \$224.69 – \$344.57 Market Cap **\$4.53T**

AAPL: Mac Refresh Signals Real AI Push, Not Just Talk

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple dropped new Mac Mini and Mac Studio desktops aimed specifically at AI developers — this is a small news item but a big signal. Apple is quietly repositioning its Mac line as an on-device AI workstation, which matters because it's the first tangible product move that says "we're not letting Nvidia own every AI dollar." Stock barely moved (+0.32%) because the market wants to see revenue, not press releases.
- Nvidia earnings tomorrow (Aug 26) are the real macro event — if Nvidia beats, the whole AI trade including AAPL gets a lift. If they disappoint on Rubin (their next-gen chip), expect a broad tech pullback that drags Apple with it even though Apple has zero direct exposure.

WHY IT MATTERS

The options flow is screaming bullish — a 0.39 put/call ratio (meaning traders are buying 2.5x more upside bets than downside protection) plus unusual call buying at \$312.50 and \$315 tells me smart money is positioning for a breakout this week, likely on the Nvidia halo trade. But here's the nuance: those unusual puts at \$310 are meaningful too — someone big is hedging, which suggests institutions think there's upside but want protection against a Nvidia miss. The insider selling from the General Counsel is routine (same size, two weeks apart — that's a pre-scheduled 10b5-1 plan, not a signal). Bigger picture: at \$4.53T market cap and 71% of the 52-week range, AAPL is priced for continued execution but not perfection — any AI product miss or China headline can knock 5-10% off fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The two policy issues that actually move Apple right now: (1) China tariffs — the Trump administration's ongoing tariff framework still exempts most consumer electronics, but that exemption is reviewed periodically and any expansion of tariffs to iPhones would hit margins by an estimated 3-5% since Apple still assembles ~80% of iPhones in China despite India diversification; (2) The DOJ antitrust case on the Google Search default deal is still working through appeals — Apple gets ~\$20B/year from Google to be Safari's default search engine, which is nearly 15% of its operating profit. If courts force that deal to end, it's a real earnings hit. Also watching the EU's Digital Markets Act enforcement — ongoing App Store fine risk in the low billions.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$310.34
12M Price Target	\$355.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.4%
Market Cap	\$4.53T
FY2026E Revenue	\$435M
FY2027E Revenue	\$468M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.75
Fwd P/E	39.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$315.00	\$295.00
6 Months	\$345.00	\$325.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$380.00	\$355.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$440.00	\$390.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$480.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.70%) leading is a defensive tell — money is rotating toward safety ahead of Nvidia earnings. Financials strong on higher-for-longer rate expectations.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary only +0.24% — despite AAPL technically being in tech, its consumer exposure means it moves with discretionary spending sentiment, which is soft.

ROTATION WATCH: The defensive lean today (staples, utilities, financials leading over tech) suggests investors are de-risking before Nvidia. If Nvidia beats, expect a violent rotation back into mega-cap tech and AAPL rips higher on the coattails.

RELATED PLAY: If Apple's AI push is real, TSMC (which makes Apple's chips) benefits directly — and TSMC is already flagged for a post-Nvidia pop. Also watch semiconductor equipment names that supply both.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Everyone's positioning ahead of tomorrow's print — Rubin chip debut is the AI story this week
- TSM (TSMC): Motley Fool flagging it as the post-Nvidia beneficiary since they manufacture the chips

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging pure-play AI names badly this year — it's up modestly while NVDA and semis have run hard. That's actually the setup for a catch-up trade IF Apple's AI story starts converting to revenue. Right now AAPL is the "defensive AI" play — you get exposure to the theme without the boom-bust risk of the chip names.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$305-310 on pullbacks; add aggressively under \$295

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation above 25%, DOJ antitrust ruling forces Google Search deal unwind, or iPhone unit sales down >8% YoY

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair with a short on a China-exposed hardware peer

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$175.89 ▼ 2.25%	12M Price Target \$190.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$422.67B
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PLTR: Insider Selling and Bearish Puts Weigh Despite AI Tailwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR is down 2.25% this morning despite being named Zacks' "Bull of the Day" — that tells you sentiment is mixed. The bigger tell is that five billionaire money managers dumped PLTR last quarter (per Motley Fool piece), which pairs badly with insider Jeffrey Buckley selling ~\$500K worth of shares over the past week.
- Options flow is flashing bearish — big put buying at \$170 and \$175 strikes expiring this week means traders are betting on (or hedging against) more downside near-term. Put/call ratio of 0.66 isn't screaming panic, but the unusual put volume at 2x+ open interest is a yellow flag.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading between the lines: PLTR is trading at 69% of its 52-week range with a \$422B market cap on ~\$4B in revenue — that's roughly 100x sales, which means the stock is priced for perfection. When smart money (billionaires, insiders) starts trimming at these levels, it usually means they see the risk/reward as skewed, not that the story is broken. The bigger picture is that Palantir remains THE beneficiary of the Trump admin's defense modernization and "AI-first government" posture — the Army's TITAN program, the Maven Smart System expansion, and ICE's data infrastructure work all flow through them. But at this valuation, the question isn't "is the business good" (it clearly is) — it's "how much good news is already baked in?" Answer: a lot.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2027 defense budget markup is happening in Congress right now, and the House Armed Services Committee has signaled continued growth in software-defined warfare line items — that's directly bullish for PLTR's Gotham platform. Separately, watch the ongoing debate around federal AI procurement rules under the OMB's updated M-24-10 memo — Palantir is already FedRAMP High authorized, which is a moat because smaller AI competitors will spend 12-18 months getting there. The wildcard is any Democratic pushback on ICE contracts if the political winds shift ahead of midterms — PLTR's civil-liberties baggage is a real headline risk even if the revenue impact is small.

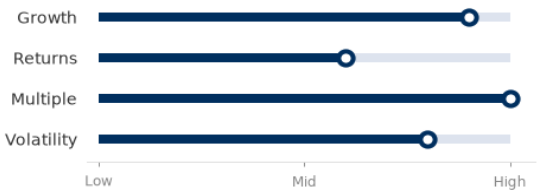
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$175, investors are paying roughly \$100 for every \$1 of revenue — that's not just expensive, it's historically expensive for ANY software company, let alone one growing 40-50%. For comparison, high-flying peers like Snowflake and CrowdStrike trade at 15-20x sales. The only way this multiple makes sense is if PLTR's commercial AIP business scales into a \$20B+ revenue company in 5 years — possible, but you're paying today's price for a 2030 outcome.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$175.89
12M Price Target	\$190.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.0%
Market Cap	\$422.67B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.85
Fwd P/E	284.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$180.00	\$160.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$190.00	\$150.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$195.00	\$130.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$230.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$70.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.70%) and Financials (+1.29%) are leading — that's a defensive rotation, meaning money is getting cautious rather than chasing growth. Financials specifically benefit from the steepening yield curve narrative.

COOLING OFF: Tech and Comm Services are lagging the tape today — the AI trade is taking a breather, which is exactly why PLTR is down despite good news flow.

ROTATION WATCH: The move into staples on a day when tech is soft suggests risk-off positioning ahead of Jackson Hole aftermath and month-end rebalancing. This is a headwind for high-multiple names like PLTR specifically.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI exposure without paying 100x sales, look at the "picks and shovels" — data center REITs like DLR and EQIX, or the power infrastructure names benefiting from AI energy demand.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- EVLV (Evolv Technologies): Ticking up on AI security narrative — smaller-cap AI plays getting bid as an alternative to expensive megacaps.
- AMBA (Ambarella): Edge AI chips catching a bid as investors look for AI infrastructure exposure beyond NVDA.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is lagging its AI peer group today despite being called Zacks' Bull of the Day — that's a tell. When a stock can't rally on its own bullish research, it usually means institutional holders are using strength to trim. Watch if \$170 breaks; that's where the put wall lives and a break could accelerate down to \$160.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, I'm cautious on the price. This isn't a "pound the table" moment, it's a "own some, wait for pullbacks to add" setup.

POSITION SIZE: Keep it at 2-3% of portfolio — the story is real but the valuation risk is also real, and this thing can drop 20% in a week when AI sentiment shifts.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$150-160, which would be a ~15% haircut and closer to the 200-day moving average. Chasing at \$175+ with insider selling and bearish options flow is asking for pain.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is commercial AIP revenue crossing 50% of total revenue mix, which would validate PLTR as more than a government contractor.

WHEN TO BAIL: If revenue growth drops below 25% YoY, if they lose a major DoD contract renewal, or if commercial AIP customer counts flatline for two straight quarters.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option 10% below current price expiring 3 months out. Costs you a small insurance premium but caps your downside if the AI trade rolls over.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy

\$262.07 ▲ 1.33%

12M Price Target
\$310.00

52-Week Range
\$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap
\$2.83T

AMZN: Hyperscaler Tailwinds Building Into Nvidia Print

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN up 1.3% and sitting at 72% of its 52-week range — the tape is warming up ahead of Nvidia earnings Wednesday, which the market is treating as a referendum on the whole AI trade. If Jensen sounds confident on guidance, hyperscalers like AMZN (who are the ones actually BUYING all those Nvidia chips for AWS) rip with him.
- Cramer's "data center backlash favors big tech hyperscalers" note is actually a real signal — local communities are fighting new data centers over power/water use, which sounds bad but is a moat for incumbents who already have the sites, permits, and utility relationships locked in.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the read: the options flow is screaming bullish (put/call ratio of 0.56 means traders are buying almost twice as many upside bets as downside protection), and someone dropped \$14M on near-term calls at \$247.50 — that's a directional bet, not a hedge. Combine that with the data center NIMBY backlash and you get a counterintuitive setup: political friction that looks like a headwind is actually building a moat around AMZN, MSFT, and GOOG because they're the only ones who can afford to negotiate with governors for power allocations. The CEO of Amazon Stores selling \$1M in stock sounds scary but it's routine post-vest selling on a scheduled plan — not a red flag. Nvidia's print Wednesday is the near-term catalyst; a beat pulls AMZN toward \$270+, a miss drags it back to \$255 support.

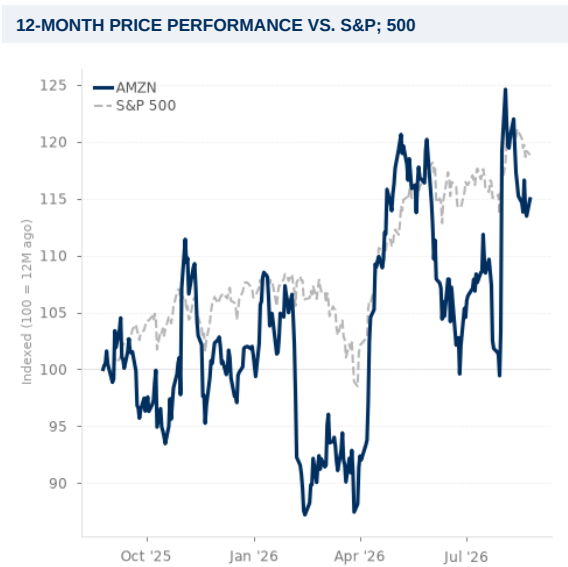
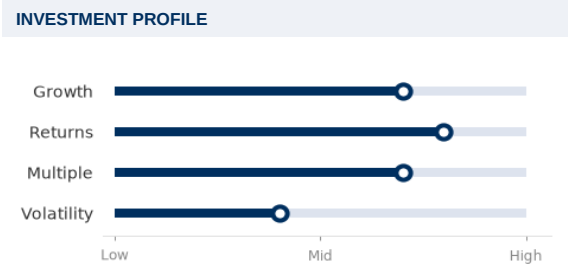
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the AI Diffusion Rule and export controls the Commerce Department is still tweaking — if they loosen restrictions on chip exports to allied countries, AWS's international cloud regions get a growth unlock. On the flip side, the FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is grinding forward in 2026, and any adverse ruling on the marketplace/Prime bundling could force structural changes — that's the sleeper risk nobody's pricing in. Also keep an eye on state-level data center legislation (Virginia and Georgia are debating tax breaks vs. restrictions) — this directly determines where AWS can expand cheapest.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$2.83T market cap and roughly 38x forward earnings, you're paying \$38 for every \$1 of profit Amazon is expected to make next year — not cheap, but reasonable for a business where AWS is growing ~19% with expanding margins. Compared to Microsoft (~32x) and Google (~22x), AMZN sits in the middle of the hyperscaler pack, which feels fair given retail is a lower-margin drag. The valuation is justified IF AWS growth stays above 17% — below that, the multiple compresses fast.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$262.07
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.3%
Market Cap	\$2.83T
FY2026E Revenue	\$743M
FY2027E Revenue	\$820M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	38.3x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$270.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$260.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) leading is a defensive tell — money is hedging even while chasing tech. Cloud/AI names are also warming as Nvidia print approaches.

COOLING OFF: Utilities gave back 2% over five days despite the AI power narrative — market may be sensing peak power-demand hype.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating into "AI infrastructure winners with moats" — that's exactly AMZN's bucket. The data center backlash story is catalyzing this because it eliminates would-be competitors.

RELATED PLAY: If the hyperscaler thesis works, the picks-and-shovels plays win too — think Vertiv (VRT) for cooling, Eaton (ETN) for power management, and Equinix (EQIX) for interconnection.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Azure AI revenue growth is the benchmark everyone measures AWS against — if MSFT keeps winning, AMZN has to prove it's not losing share
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Google Cloud has been the fastest-growing hyperscaler by percentage — showing enterprise AI demand is real and broad

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is roughly in-line with the mega-cap tech pack but at 72% of its 52-week range, it's not overheated — MSFT and NVDA are closer to their highs. That relative underperformance actually sets up a catch-up trade if Nvidia's print goes well.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Solid setup with real catalysts, but Nvidia earnings risk keeps me from pounding the table this week

POSITION SIZE: 5-7% — this is a core holding, not a trade; the business is durable and diversified enough to size up

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on any pullback to \$255-260, especially if Nvidia disappoints and drags the whole complex down — that's your gift

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, waiting for AWS growth re-acceleration to become undeniable in Q4/Q1 prints

WHEN TO BAIL: If AWS growth drops below 15% two quarters in a row, or the FTC gets a structural remedy — thesis is broken

HEDGING: Simple approach — buy a small put spread expiring after Nvidia earnings (limits your downside if AI trade cracks). Or just keep some cash on the side to buy the dip rather than trying to time hedges.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$135.00 ▼ 1.44%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.78T
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SPCX: Space ETF Consolidates as SpaceX Valuation Debate Heats Up

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX is basically flat overnight (-1.4%) after a rough week — it's down roughly 6% from last Tuesday. The main drag: semiconductor stocks are dragging the whole Nasdaq lower (chips are heavily used in satellites and space hardware, so when chips sneeze, space catches a cold).
- GuruFocus dropped a piece this morning called "SpaceX's Valuation Divide Is Getting Hard to Ignore" — this matters because SPCX holds space-adjacent public names, and any repricing of the private space leader (SpaceX at ~\$400B) sets the tone for the whole sector's multiples.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: SPCX sits at only 25% of its 52-week range, meaning it's much closer to the yearly low (\$105) than the high (\$226). That's a big drawdown from the highs, and it tells me the market already priced in some Golden Dome/defense enthusiasm and is now digesting whether the follow-through spending actually shows up. The bearish options flow (that \$200 strike put buying for August expiry) suggests some traders are betting the bounce fails short-term — but the aggressive \$135 call buying at 2.3x open interest means someone thinks we're near a floor. Net-net: this feels like a stock waiting for a catalyst — either the FY2027 defense appropriations bill clarity or a big commercial launch contract — before it picks a direction.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy story for space right now is the Trump administration's "Golden Dome" missile defense initiative — a Reagan-era Star Wars concept revived, requiring hundreds of new satellites and ground systems. Congress is actively debating funding levels in the FY2027 defense authorization, with the Space Force budget potentially topping \$40B (vs ~\$29B a couple years ago). If that passes intact, SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and defense-space contractors get a multi-year revenue runway; if it gets slashed in reconciliation, this stock has more downside. Also watch FCC spectrum policy — satellite broadband players need spectrum wins to compete with Starlink.

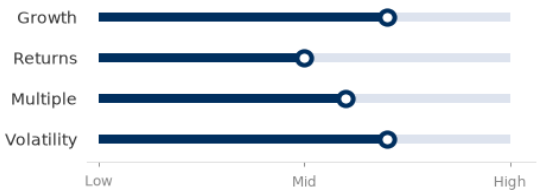
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX is an ETF, so traditional P/E and EV/EBITDA don't quite apply — you're really buying a basket where the underlying holdings trade at wildly different multiples (Rocket Lab at 30x sales, mature comms sats at 2x sales). Being at 25% of the 52-week range means the ETF's implied "sector multiple" has compressed meaningfully — investors are paying about 40% less per dollar of space exposure than they were at the highs. That's not screaming cheap, but it's reasonable if you believe defense space spending accelerates from here.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$135.00
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.8%
Market Cap	\$1.78T
FY2026E Revenue	\$0K
FY2027E Revenue	\$0K
FY2026E EPS	\$0.00
FY2027E EPS	\$0.00
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$145.00	\$138.00	\$125.00
6 Months	\$165.00	\$150.00	\$120.00
1 Year	\$190.00	\$155.00	\$110.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$250.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$550.00	\$380.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.3%) leading — that's a defensive rotation, meaning money is moving to safer, boring stuff. Not a great backdrop for high-beta space names.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors dragging the tape today — since satellites are essentially chips in space, this is a direct headwind for SPCX holdings.

ROTATION WATCH: The staples/financials leadership tells me investors are de-risking ahead of Jackson Hole aftermath and end-of-summer positioning. Risk-on sectors like space need a catalyst to break out of this consolidation.

RELATED PLAY: If Golden Dome funding gets green-lit, the ground infrastructure names (data centers, radar systems, cybersecurity for satellite networks) get a second-order boost — think Palantir on the software side and Leidos on the systems integration side.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning on launch cadence and the Neutron rocket program — becoming the credible #2 to SpaceX.
- LMT (Lockheed Martin): Defense giant with major Space Force contracts — benefits directly from Golden Dome regardless of which subcontractor wins.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its pure-play holdings because the ETF includes some mature, slower-growing satellite comms names that are weighing on returns. If you have high conviction on specific space plays, individual names outperform; SPCX is the "I want the theme without picking winners" trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term space thesis but the near-term setup is murky with defensive rotation happening and chips weak.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a thematic ETF, not a core holding. Enough to matter if space rips, not enough to hurt if the theme cools.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd scale in around \$125-130 on macro fear days. Full-size add only if we retest the \$110-115 lows with the defense bill still on track.

TIME HORIZON: 18-36 months — you're waiting for the defense spending cycle to fully flow through and potentially for a Starlink IPO to bring space back into the spotlight.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Golden Dome funding gets gutted in reconciliation, or if we break below \$105 on high volume (that's a technical breakdown), the thesis is broken.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just keeping some dry powder — don't go max size here. If you want to get fancier, pair this with a small position in a defensive ETF like consumer staples so when risk-off days hit, one leg cushions the other.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$103.62 ▼ 4.17%	12M Price Target \$110.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$93.16B
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HOOD: Crypto Rally Fuels Rip, But CLARITY Act Vote Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD ripped 14% on Thursday (\$95 → \$108) then gave back 4% Monday. The move lines up perfectly with bitcoin wiping out three months of losses in a week and crypto exchange volumes doubling in five days — HOOD makes real money on crypto trading, so this is a direct earnings kicker, not just vibes.
- The bigger catalyst though: the CLARITY Act (the big crypto market structure bill) is heading to a 60-vote Senate hurdle right after a White House crypto meeting. Traders are front-running a regulatory green light for tokenized assets — which is exactly what Vlad Tenev has been publicly betting the company on.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: HOOD has quietly become a leveraged bet on crypto policy, not just crypto prices. If the CLARITY Act clears the Senate, it legally blesses tokenized stocks, bonds, and real-world assets — which is Tenev's entire product roadmap. That's why the stock is up ~60% from its 52-week low even though earnings haven't fundamentally changed. The flip side worth chewing on: the options flow is screaming caution. Big money is buying September \$170-\$180 puts in unusual size — that's someone paying real premium to bet the stock falls 60%+ in a month, which usually means they're either hedging a huge long position OR they know something about the Senate vote math. Either way, the risk/reward here is asymmetric in a scary way — pricing already assumes the bill passes.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

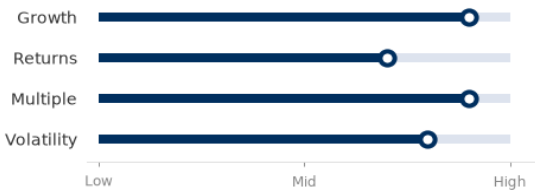
The CLARITY Act is THE story — it's the bill that would finally decide whether crypto tokens are securities (SEC's turf, restrictive) or commodities (CFTC's turf, permissive). It needs 60 Senate votes, which means Democrats have to cross over, and last week's White House meeting suggests the administration is pushing hard. If it passes: HOOD can legally offer tokenized US stocks to a global audience — a massive TAM expansion. If it fails or gets watered down: the tokenization thesis gets pushed out 12-18 months and this stock has a lot of air underneath it. Also watch: the SEC's evolving stance on staking and prediction markets — both are HOOD product lines now.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$103.62
12M Price Target	\$110.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.2%
Market Cap	\$93.16B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	56.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$120.00	\$105.00	\$88.00
6 Months	\$140.00	\$110.00	\$80.00
1 Year	\$160.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$130.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$175.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Financials (+1.3% today, +1.1% week) are catching a bid as rate-cut expectations firm up and crypto rallies drag capital markets names higher. Anything crypto-adjacent (exchanges, miners, custody) is in favor as CLARITY Act headlines flow.

COOLING OFF: Utilities weak on the week (-2.2%) as risk-on rotation pulls money out of defensive dividend payers. Consumer Discretionary underperforming despite the tape being green.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly rotating into risk-on/crypto beta and out of safe-haven trades. That's a tailwind for HOOD but also means it's a "high beta" moment — meaning when the tape rolls over, HOOD falls harder than the market.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the tokenization thesis but want less earnings volatility, the crypto infrastructure names (COIN, custodians, stablecoin issuers) benefit from the same policy tailwind without being as exposed to retail trading volumes.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Same CLARITY Act tailwind, more direct crypto exposure — usually leads HOOD on these policy trades.
- MSTR (Strategy): Bitcoin proxy — up big on the BTC recovery, and it's the purest way to play crypto direction.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is roughly tracking COIN on this move but with more torque from the tokenization narrative that's specifically Tenev's baby. If HOOD starts lagging COIN meaningfully in coming days, that tells you the market is losing faith in the tokenization-specific story and just trading it as generic crypto beta.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$88-95 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-18 months

Thesis Invalidation: CLARITY Act fails Senate + bitcoin rolls back under \$90k

Hedging: Buy Sept puts or pair long with short COIN

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy \$559.02 ▲ 1.66% 12M Price Target \$640.00 52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap \$1.42T

META: Antitrust Trial Resumes, AI Monetization Story Building

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is up ~3% over the past week and closed +1.66% yesterday at \$559 — but here's the thing: it's still stuck near the BOTTOM of its 52-week range (14% of range). Translation: this is a beaten-down mega-cap that's just starting to wake up. The catalyst is a mix of the FTC antitrust trial resuming (which the market seems to think META will survive intact) and growing buzz around Meta's new "Hatch" AI agent platform, which is their first real attempt to make money directly from consumer AI (not just ads).
- Cramer flagged that the "data center backlash" (communities pushing back on power-hungry AI facilities) actually HELPS the hyperscalers like Meta because they've already secured their land, power, and permits — smaller players can't catch up. That's a moat forming in real time.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading between the lines: the CFO sold ~\$2.7M of stock on Aug 18, which sounds bearish, but insider selling at mega-caps is usually just tax planning — and it happened BEFORE the recent rally, so they're leaving money on the table. Meanwhile, options flow is screaming bullish (put/call ratio of 0.31 means traders are buying 3x more upside bets than downside protection) with unusual call buying at \$555-\$565 strikes — someone with size thinks this pops through \$565 into month-end. The bigger picture: META is trading like the antitrust trial is going badly, but if they get a "monitor and modify" outcome (likely) instead of a forced Instagram/WhatsApp breakup (unlikely), you get an immediate re-rating. That's the setup — cheap stock + bullish flow + binary catalyst that's tilted in their favor.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

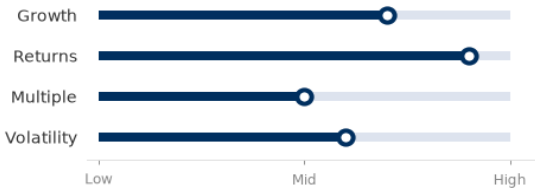
The FTC antitrust trial is THE story — the government wants to unwind Meta's Instagram and WhatsApp acquisitions from a decade ago. Base case is a settlement or narrow ruling (behavioral remedies, not structural breakup), which would be a massive relief rally. Secondary policy watch: the Trump administration's AI executive orders have been pro-hyperscaler (loose regulation, fast permitting for data centers), which is a direct tailwind — and the EU's Digital Markets Act fines are the ongoing headwind (~\$200M-\$1B range, annoying but not material to a \$1.4T company). Bottom line: US policy is friendlier to META than it's been in years, EU is hostile but priced in.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$559.02
12M Price Target	\$640.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.5%
Market Cap	\$1.42T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$222M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	20.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$590.00	\$565.00	\$525.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$610.00	\$490.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$640.00	\$460.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$720.00	\$440.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$400.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$1100.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.3%) leading — that's a defensive-plus-rate-cut trade, suggesting the market is bracing for a slowdown but expecting the Fed to cushion it. Utilities also up on the AI power demand story.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary lagging (+0.24%) — consumer is getting tired, which is a yellow flag for ad-supported businesses like META because ad budgets are the first thing companies cut in a slowdown.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating back into mega-cap tech (Comm Services +0.83%) as bond yields stabilize — META benefits directly because it's the cheapest name in the Mag 7 group.

RELATED PLAY: If META's AI infrastructure story keeps working, the picks-and-shovels plays (Nvidia obviously, but also data center REITs like DLR and EQIX, and power utilities like VST and CEG that feed the data centers) all catch a bid.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Every dollar META spends on AI infrastructure lands on Nvidia's income statement — direct beneficiary of hyperscaler capex.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Similar antitrust overhang, similar cheap multiple, similar AI story — trades in sympathy with META on any positive regulatory news.

META CONTEXT: META is LAGGING its Mag 7 peers badly — it's at 14% of its 52-week range while Nvidia and Microsoft are near highs. That's either a warning sign or an opportunity, and given the earnings power and cheap multiple, I think it's opportunity. When the antitrust cloud clears, this is the mean-reversion trade in mega-cap tech.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$540-550 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-18 months

Thesis Invalidation: Adverse FTC ruling forcing Instagram/WhatsApp divestiture, or ad revenue growth dropping below 10%

Hedging: Buy protective puts around FTC ruling dates, or pair with a short on GOOGL if you want pure META alpha

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$910.43 ▼ 5.83%	12M Price Target \$1100.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Chip Selloff Overdone, CHIPS Act Tailwind Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU dropped 5.8% yesterday as the whole chip complex got hammered — this wasn't MU-specific news, it was fresh US sanctions on Iran spooking risk assets and traders taking profits on the biggest AI winners (MU is up ~981% off its lows, per that Motley Fool piece). Classic "sell what worked" day.
- Futures are green pre-bell and MU is called higher — Treasury yields dropping (meaning bond investors are getting less nervous, which is good for expensive growth stocks) is bringing the dip-buyers back into semis.

WHY IT MATTERS

This looks like a shakeout, not a top. The unusual call buying at \$900/\$910/\$915 strikes (nearly \$50M in notional bets) tells me smart money used yesterday's dump to load up on upside — they think this bounces fast. Bigger picture: the CHIPS and Science Act is still funneling billions into Micron's Idaho and New York fabs, and the Trump administration's push to reshore semiconductor manufacturing has only intensified with the recent tariff framework on Chinese-made chips. That's a structural moat — Micron is one of the few US-domiciled memory makers, which matters more every quarter as export controls tighten.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) the ongoing implementation of Section 232 semiconductor tariffs — if the administration expands them to cover finished memory products imported from Korea, that's a direct win for Micron vs. Samsung and SK Hynix. (2) Congress is debating an extension/expansion of the CHIPS Act investment tax credit (the 25% credit for fab construction) — if that gets bumped to 35% in the year-end tax package, MU's roughly \$50B in planned US capex gets meaningfully cheaper. The regulatory wind is firmly at their back right now.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

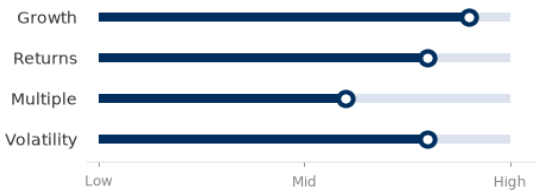
At ~\$910, MU trades around 46x this year's earnings and ~22x EV/EBITDA — meaning investors are paying \$46 for every \$1 of profit and roughly \$22 for every \$1 of cash operating profit. That's not cheap on the surface, but memory is cyclical and we're likely mid-cycle, not late — HBM (high-bandwidth memory that goes into every Nvidia GPU) is sold out through 2026, and pricing is still rising. Compared to Nvidia at 40x+ forward earnings with slower growth ahead, MU actually looks reasonably priced for the AI exposure you're getting.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$910.43
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.8%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$61,200M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$19.80
Fwd P/E	64.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$960.00	\$830.00
6 Months	\$1200.00	\$1050.00	\$780.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1100.00	\$720.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1350.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$3500.00	\$2200.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples and Financials led yesterday — classic defensive rotation on the Iran sanctions headline. Financials also benefiting from the yield curve steepening story.

COOLING OFF: Semis and mega-cap tech took the brunt of the selling — but this feels like profit-taking, not a trend change. Nothing fundamental broke.

ROTATION WATCH: Money briefly rotated to safety yesterday but is already flowing back into tech pre-market. The question is whether this is a one-day flush or the start of a broader "de-risk the AI trade" move — I lean flush.

RELATED PLAY: If MU bounces, watch the memory equipment names (Lam Research, Applied Materials) — they sell the tools MU uses to build fabs, and CHIPS Act money flows through them too.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Bouncing pre-market with MU — every HBM chip MU sells goes into an NVDA GPU, so they trade together.
- SNDK (Sandisk): Called out in the IBD headline as rallying — NAND flash pricing is firming alongside DRAM, which is a positive read-through for MU's storage business.

MU CONTEXT: MU is roughly in-line with peers on the bounce, which tells me the selloff was macro/sentiment-driven, not company-specific. If it were leading the recovery, I'd say buy aggressively; since it's in-line, treat this as a normal dip-buy opportunity rather than a screaming bargain.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — I like this setup a lot; the only reason it's not a 9 is the stock has already run 981% and cyclical don't go up forever.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on dips to \$880-910; if we get a real washout to \$830, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is FY2027 HBM revenue ramping plus potential CHIPS Act credit expansion in the year-end tax bill.

WHEN TO BAIL: HBM ASPs decline sequentially for two straight quarters, OR Samsung officially qualifies at Nvidia's next-gen platform, OR the stock breaks \$780 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: If you're nervous, buy puts around \$850 for downside insurance (costs a bit but caps your loss), or pair the long with a short in a weaker DRAM name so you're betting on MU being the best-in-class winner rather than betting on the whole sector.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$348.95 ▼ 3.83%	12M Price Target \$375.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.38T
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TSLA: Cybertruck Price Hike Signals Demand Problem

WHAT HAPPENED

- Tesla just RAISED Cybertruck prices by \$5K even though sales are down 32% year-over-year — that's counterintuitive and the market read it as a red flag. Normally you cut prices when demand drops; hiking prices into weakness usually means they're trying to protect margins because they can't fix volumes. Stock's down ~3.8% on it.
- Options desks are loading up on near-term puts — the \$355/\$357.50/\$360 strikes are seeing 8-15x normal volume. That's institutions paying real money to bet the stock keeps sliding into month-end.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Cybertruck price hike is a tell — it says Tesla thinks they've squeezed all the demand they can from current pricing and would rather protect gross margin (profit per truck sold) than chase volume. That's a defensive move, not an offensive one, and it confirms what bears have been saying: the core EV business is maturing faster than the bulls want to admit. The real question isn't Cybertruck anymore — it's whether robotaxi and Optimus (the humanoid robot) can scale before the auto business flatlines. With the "Big Beautiful Bill" having killed the \$7,500 EV tax credit as of Sept 30, 2025, Tesla is now selling into a headwind their competitors also face — but Tesla loses the most in absolute dollars because they sell the most EVs.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two policy threads matter most right now: (1) The federal EV tax credit is already dead, but states like California are debating replacement rebates — if those pass, it's a partial offset but nothing like the old \$7,500 credit. (2) The bigger deal is NHTSA's evolving framework for autonomous vehicles — the Trump administration has signaled a lighter federal touch on self-driving rules, which is a massive tailwind for Tesla's robotaxi ambitions in Austin and beyond. Musk's fractured-then-repaired relationship with the White House is worth watching; if he's back in favor, expect friendlier autonomy rules, if he's out, expect delays.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$1.38T market cap and roughly 160x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$160 for every \$1 of profit Tesla is expected to make next year — this is priced like a tech company, not a car company (Ford trades around 7x). The premium is entirely a bet on robotaxi and Optimus succeeding; strip those out and the stock is worth maybe half of where it trades. So the question isn't "is it expensive" (it obviously is) — it's "do you believe the AI story enough to pay up."

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

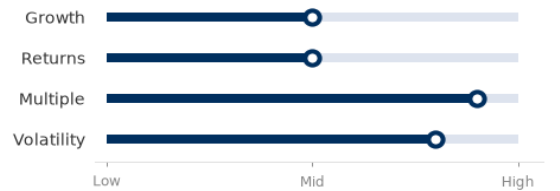
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-25 13:26 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.95
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.5%
Market Cap	\$1.38T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	162.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$380.00	\$345.00	\$310.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$360.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$520.00	\$375.00	\$240.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$420.00	\$200.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.3%) — classic defensive/rate-sensitive rotation, suggests the market is getting cautious on growth names heading into fall.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is barely positive (+0.24%) despite being where TSLA lives — that's a tell that big-ticket consumer spending (cars, trucks, luxury goods) is softening.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving toward safety, not risk — that's a headwind for high-multiple names like Tesla. When staples outperform discretionary, retail demand for \$80K trucks is usually next to weaken.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI/autonomy exposure without Tesla's baggage, look at the chip suppliers (NVDA for AI compute) or lidar/sensor plays that supply the broader autonomous stack — they win regardless of which robotaxi company wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- BYDDY (BYD): Eating Tesla's lunch in China and Europe with cheaper EVs and better hybrid options — they don't need US tax credits.
- GOOGL (Alphabet/Waymo): Waymo is already doing paid robotaxi rides at scale in multiple cities while Tesla is still in pilot mode in Austin.

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is lagging its "AI" narrative peers and its EV peers simultaneously right now — sitting at just 26% of its 52-week range tells you the momentum crowd has moved on. Until there's a robotaxi milestone or a delivery beat, it's a show-me stock.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — Cautiously neutral. The AI optionality is real but the price already reflects a lot of hope, and near-term catalysts skew negative.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% max. This isn't a "back up the truck" setup — it's a "own some in case Musk pulls a rabbit out of the hat" position.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$300-\$320 (the low end of the 52-week range) before adding meaningfully. Chasing at \$349 with put flow this heavy is asking to catch a knife.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being robotaxi expansion beyond Austin and any Optimus production announcement.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Q3 deliveries drop more than 15% YoY, or if there's a serious robotaxi safety incident, or if auto gross margin (ex-credits) breaks below 15% — any of those, cut it.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying protective puts 3-6 months out at 10% below your entry — think of it as insurance you pay a small premium for. Or pair a TSLA long with a small BYD long to be neutral on "EV winner" and just bet on the category.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$208.48 ▼ 2.91%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.05T
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NVDA: Jitters Into Earnings, But Setup Still Bullish

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down ~5% over five days and dropped 2.9% yesterday on heavy volume (135M shares — well above average). This is classic pre-earnings de-risking — NVDA reports Wednesday after the bell, and traders are trimming positions rather than hold through a binary event. Nothing fundamentally broke.
- Options flow is telling a different story though — put/call ratio of 0.46 (meaning 2x more bullish call bets than bearish puts) and unusual call buying at \$207.50 and \$212.50 strikes. Somebody with real money is betting on a bounce post-earnings.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the setup: the stock is weak going into earnings but smart money is positioning bullishly through options — that divergence usually resolves in favor of the options crowd because they're making conviction bets, not just managing risk. The real question Wednesday isn't the revenue number (that'll be huge) — it's Jensen Huang's guidance on China. The Trump administration's revenue-sharing deal on H2O chip sales to China (announced earlier this year, where NVDA gives the US government 15% of China chip revenue) is either going to be validated as a workable arrangement or blow up. If Jensen sounds confident, this thing rips back to \$230+ fast. If he hedges on China, we chop around \$200 for a while.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: the H2O China chip revenue-sharing arrangement with the Trump administration is still being tested — NVDA is essentially paying a 15% "tax" to Washington to keep selling to China, which is unprecedented and legally shaky (some in Congress are calling it unconstitutional). Watch for any court challenge or Congressional pushback that could unwind it. Separately, the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress could bring more domestic manufacturing subsidies — good for NVDA's TSMC-alternative supply chain, but potentially forces them to build more in Arizona at higher cost. Also keep an eye on the EU AI Act enforcement kicking in — compliance costs are real but favor scale players like NVDA over smaller rivals.

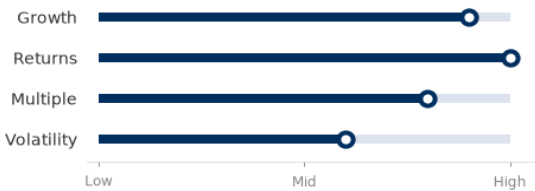
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$208, NVDA trades at roughly 43x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$43 for every \$1 of profit expected next year. That sounds expensive until you realize earnings are still growing 40%+ annually, so the "PEG ratio" (price-to-earnings divided by growth rate) is about 1.0 — that's actually reasonable for a mega-cap. Compare to peers: AMD trades at 35x with much slower growth, so NVDA's premium is earned. Not cheap, but not stupid either.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$208.48
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+24.7%
Market Cap	\$5.05T
FY2027E Revenue	\$215M
FY2028E Revenue	\$275M
FY2027E EPS	\$4.85
FY2028E EPS	\$6.40
Fwd P/E	43.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$235.00	\$220.00	\$195.00
6 Months	\$260.00	\$235.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$310.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$420.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.29%) leading today — that's defensive rotation, meaning money is getting cautious ahead of NVDA earnings because a bad print takes down the whole market. Utilities also up on the AI-power-demand thesis (data centers need electricity).

COOLING OFF: Tech is quietly soft — semis specifically are getting de-risked. This is normal pre-NVDA jitters, not a real sector breakdown.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is temporarily parking in defensives waiting for the NVDA print. If NVDA delivers, expect a violent rotation BACK into tech Thursday morning. This is a "coiled spring" setup.

RELATED PLAY: The AMD/Intel bounce on the Pelosi disclosure is interesting — when politicians buy semis, retail follows. If you want NVDA exposure without single-name risk, the SMH semiconductor ETF gets you the whole basket. Data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) are the second-order play on the same AI thesis.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): Up 3% on strong buy upgrade + Pelosi buying disclosure — the political tailwind is real
- INTC (Intel): Also up 3% — CHIPS Act subsidies and domestic manufacturing narrative getting fresh attention

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is lagging its peer group this week, which is actually normal pre-earnings behavior — the biggest name gets de-risked hardest. Historically NVDA lags into the print then leads out of it if the print is good. The fact that AMD/INTC are rallying tells me the AI trade is alive; NVDA weakness is idiosyncratic, not sector-wide.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$200-210 pre-earnings, \$185 if post-earnings selloff

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Data center revenue growth drops below 30% YoY or full China export ban with no workaround

Hedging: Buy Sept puts at \$190 strike as earnings insurance — costs ~1% of position

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$348.06 ▲ 0.94%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$205.65 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.26T
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GOOGL: Buffett Doubles Down as AI Moat Deepens

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock popped nearly 1% to \$348 on the back of Buffett headlines — Berkshire keeps adding to its Alphabet stake, and when the Oracle of Omaha buys a tech name (rare), retail and institutions notice. That's meaningful sentiment support at these levels.
- Google announced a Gemini AI expansion into law firms — this is the "vertical AI" playbook (selling specialized AI to specific industries at premium prices). Legal is a \$1T+ services market, so even small penetration = billions.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to actually think about: GOOGL is now at 70% of its 52-week range and options flow is screaming bullish (Put/Call at 0.41 means traders are buying 2.5x more calls than puts — they're betting UP). The big shift this year is that the market stopped pricing GOOGL as an "AI loser" (the ChatGPT-killed-Search narrative from 2023-24) and started pricing it as an "AI winner with a cash-printing Search business subsidizing the transition." That re-rating still has room to run because GOOGL trades cheaper than MSFT and META on forward earnings despite growing faster. The Brin insider "sales" are actually Rule 10b5-1 planned distributions/gifts (note the \$0 price) — don't read that as bearish, it's just noise.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The elephant in the room is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the government is still pushing for structural remedies (potentially forcing Google to divest Chrome or share Search data with rivals). A ruling on remedies is the single biggest binary event for this stock in the next 6-12 months. On the tailwind side, the Trump administration's AI Action Plan (released mid-2025) has been broadly deregulatory on AI development — that helps Google race Gemini forward without EU-style compliance drag, and federal AI procurement is expanding, where Google Cloud is winning contracts. Watch for any movement on Section 230 reform in Congress; any weakening of platform liability protections would hit YouTube directly.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$348 and roughly 35x forward earnings, you're paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit Alphabet is expected to make next year — that sounds expensive but it's actually the cheapest of the Big Tech AI plays (MSFT is ~32x with slower growth, NVDA is ~40x with more risk). The \$4.26T market cap is backed by ~\$100B in annual free cash flow, so this isn't a hope-and-dream valuation. If Search holds up and Cloud keeps growing 30%+, the multiple is justified; if antitrust breaks the business up, all bets are off.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

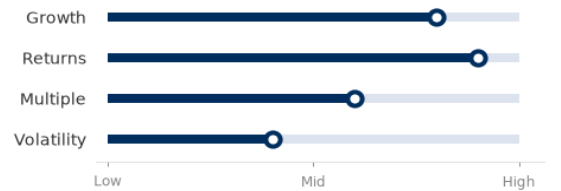
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-25 13:26 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.06
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.6%
Market Cap	\$4.26T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.60
Fwd P/E	35.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



GOOGL — Alphabet Inc. | August 25, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$352.00	\$330.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$315.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$300.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$280.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$320.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.3%) leading today suggests a mild defensive/value rotation — investors taking some risk off ahead of NVDA earnings. Comm Services (where GOOGL lives) is up modestly, which is a healthy sign — participation without froth.

COOLING OFF: Nothing dramatically red, but Consumer Discretionary lagging (+0.24%) suggests consumer-spending worries creeping back in — worth watching for ad-spend implications.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly positioning for NVDA earnings this week — if NVDA prints strong, the whole AI complex including GOOGL gets a lift; if NVDA disappoints, expect a 2-3 day drawdown across the sector.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the GOOGL AI story, the "picks and shovels" trade is data center infrastructure (VRT, ETN) or the hyperscaler cloud landlord REITs (EQIX, DLR) — they benefit whether Google, Microsoft, or Amazon wins the AI war.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Winning because their AI ad-targeting is showing measurable ROI for advertisers — the "AI actually makes money" proof point
- MSFT (Microsoft): Enterprise AI adoption via Copilot is showing up in real revenue — validates the whole hyperscaler AI thesis

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is lagging META and MSFT year-to-date on multiple, but that's the opportunity — it's the "catch-up trade" in Big Tech AI. When a stock trades at a discount to peers with similar or better growth, that gap usually closes over 12-18 months.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — This is one of the highest-quality risk/reward setups in mega-cap tech; only thing keeping it off a 9 is the DOJ overhang.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a DOJ shock doesn't wreck your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on any dip to \$338-345; if we get a market-wide flush to \$320, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts are Gemini enterprise traction, Cloud margin expansion, and DOJ resolution.

WHEN TO BAIL: Court-ordered structural breakup, two consecutive quarters of Search ad revenue decline, or Cloud growth dropping below 20%.

HEDGING: Buy cheap out-of-the-money puts (\$330 strike, a few months out) as insurance against the DOJ ruling — costs you a small premium but protects against the one thing that could really hurt this position.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy

\$229.29 ▼ 3.27%

12M Price Target
\$285.00

52-Week Range
\$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap
\$206.06B

MRVL: Alphabet Custom Chip Win Overshadowed by Sector Selloff

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL dropped 3.27% to \$229 as part of a broad semiconductor selloff — the whole chip sector got hit yesterday, which explains most of the move (not company-specific bad news). This comes after a monster run from \$216 to \$251 last week, so some profit-taking was overdue.
- The big under-the-radar story: Alphabet (Google) is reportedly sourcing custom AI chips from Marvell — this is a direct shot at Broadcom, which has owned Google's custom chip business for years. That's a huge validation of Marvell's custom silicon (ASIC) business.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Alphabet news is way more important than the 3% dip suggests — Broadcom's custom chip business with Google was worth billions and considered untouchable, so Marvell breaking in means the custom AI silicon market is opening up to a real second player. This probably means Marvell's data center revenue accelerates into 2027, and Wall Street's estimates start moving up. The options flow tells you smart money agrees — a 0.54 put/call ratio (meaning roughly 2 bullish bets for every 1 bearish bet) plus unusual call buying at \$225 shows traders are positioning for a bounce. Watch for: if MRVL earnings (coming up this week per the Barron's headline) confirm hyperscaler traction, this stock reclaims \$260+ quickly.

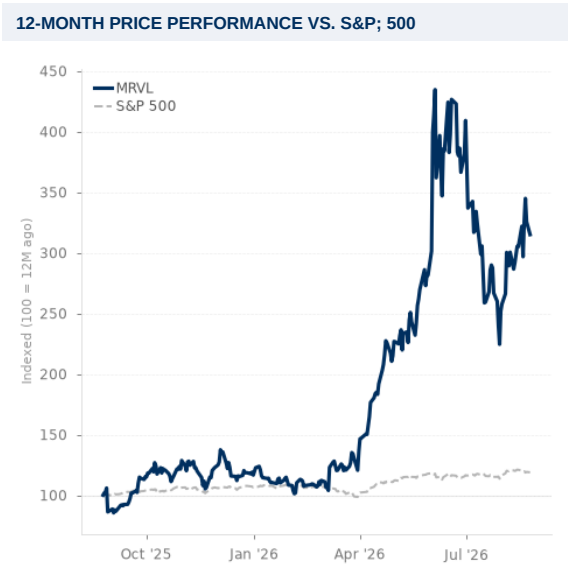
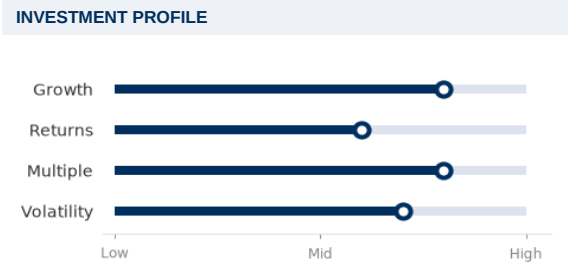
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy tailwind is the CHIPS Act implementation — Marvell doesn't manufacture chips itself (they're "fabless," meaning they design chips and pay TSMC to build them), but they benefit indirectly because CHIPS Act money is subsidizing U.S. data center buildouts that need Marvell's networking and custom silicon. The headwind to watch: expanded China export controls under the current administration, which could restrict Marvell's ability to sell into Chinese hyperscalers (roughly 15% of revenue). Also on the radar — any Congressional action on AI infrastructure spending or federal data center modernization would be a direct positive for Marvell's networking chip business.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$229, Marvell trades at roughly 80x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$80 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year — which sounds expensive until you realize NVIDIA trades at similar multiples and Broadcom is right there too. The justification is that AI-related revenue is growing 60-70% annually, so if they hit numbers, the multiple compresses fast. Bottom line: not cheap, but reasonably priced for a top-tier AI infrastructure play, especially with the Alphabet win adding a new leg to the growth story.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$229.29
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+24.3%
Market Cap	\$206.06B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	80.5x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$260.00	\$240.00	\$205.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$265.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$285.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$425.00	\$340.00	\$200.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$280.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples and Financials are catching a bid — that's classic defensive rotation, meaning some investors are getting nervous about tech and moving to safer stuff. Financials also benefit from the steeper yield curve environment.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors clearly took a breather yesterday, but this looks like profit-taking after huge runs, not a fundamental shift. No sector-killing policy news driving it.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is briefly rotating OUT of high-beta AI names into defensives ahead of key earnings (NVIDIA-adjacent names like MRVL report this week). This is tactical, not strategic — the AI capex story is still very much alive.

RELATED PLAY: If Marvell's custom silicon story keeps working, the second-order winners are the optical networking suppliers (Coherent, Lumentum) and data center REITs (Digital Realty, Equinix) that house all these AI chips.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Been the custom AI chip king — but the Alphabet news creates a real competitive threat for the first time.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure benchmark; its upcoming earnings will set the tone for the whole sector including MRVL.

MRVL CONTEXT: Marvell is now positioned as the credible #2 custom silicon player, which is a much better spot than being the #5 generic chip company. The Alphabet win means MRVL should start trading more in-line with AVGO's premium multiple rather than at a discount — that's the re-rating opportunity.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The Alphabet win is a genuine game-changer for the custom silicon narrative, and BofA just added MRVL to enhanced buy list.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but chip stocks swing hard, so don't oversize.

ENTRY POINTS: \$215-225 on sector selloff days; if you're already in, hold through earnings. Anything under \$210 is a fat pitch.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the near-term catalyst being this week's earnings and any color on the Alphabet relationship.

WHEN TO BAIL: If earnings miss badly AND guidance is cut, or if you hear news that Amazon/Alphabet is pulling custom chip work in-house. Also bail if China export controls expand to custom ASICs.

HEDGING: Simple approach — keep some cash on the side to average down if it dips to \$210, or buy a small put option (basically insurance that pays off if the stock drops) at the \$210 strike through earnings to cap your downside.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$138.43 · 1M: +20.4% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.4B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
2	SMCI Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$35.17 · 1M: +18.0% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$22.8B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$38 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
3	MDB MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$402.69 · 1M: +30.0% · P/S: 12.4x · Cap: \$32.4B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
4	PATH UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	WATCH
Price: \$16.57 · 1M: +42.6% · P/S: 5.1x · Cap: \$8.6B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$15 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
5	HII Huntington Ingalls Industries, Inc. Defense Technology	7.8/10	BUY
Price: \$294.63 · 1M: +2.2% · P/S: 0.9x · Cap: \$11.6B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			